

Xhoel Lutaj

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EDUCATION

Northern Michigan University Marquette, MI <i>Bachelor of Science, Double Major in Computer Science & Mathematics GPA: 3.98/4.0</i> • Relevant Courses: Data Structures and Algorithms, Network Programming, Computer Micro Architecture, Programming in C++, Discrete Mathematics, Calculus I, II, III • NCAA Division II Student-Athlete, Men's Soccer	Aug 2024 - May 2028
Dertliu High School Tirana, AL High School Diploma, <i>GPA: 10.0/10.0</i> Scored 10 out of 10 on all 4 subjects of the State Matura Exams.	Sep 2021 - June 2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: SQL, JavaScript, Python, Java, C#, C++, HTML/CSS Frameworks and Tools: Node.js, ASP.NET Core (Web API and MVC), Entity Framework Core, React, Next.js, Express, Git/GitHub, REST APIs Data and Databases: SQL Server, PostgreSQL, CSV/JSON/XML parsing, cleaning, validation, and conversion Certifications: Codecademy Full-Stack Engineer Career Path	
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EXPERIENCE

Software Engineering Intern EasyPay <i>C#, .NET, SQL, Python FinTech and digital wallet licensed by the Central Bank of Albania Tirana, Albania</i> • Designed and built a SQL-backed contact management application in C# and .NET with full create, read, update, and delete support, including the relational schema and queries behind it. • Built CSV and Excel export tools that pull records from the database and shape them to match a required output format. • Built an AI assistant in Python using Retrieval-Augmented Generation, connecting document retrieval to an LLM so it could answer questions from custom knowledge sources instead of guessing. • Debugged and tested features against an existing codebase to make the apps more reliable, and used Git to review code with mentors and keep quality high. • Worked through the full development cycle: building, debugging, testing, and documenting.	May 2026 - July 2026
Founder and Personal Soccer Coach Marquette, MI <i>Self-Employed</i> • Started and run a personal coaching business, training athletes one-on-one and in small groups, and handle all scheduling, client communication, and payments myself.	Aug 2025 - Present
Student-Athlete Marquette, MI <i>Northern Michigan University, Men's Soccer</i> • Balance a full course load across two majors with year-round training while holding a 3.98 GPA, relying on strong discipline and time management.	Aug 2024 - Present

PROJECTS

Gaffr, AI Soccer Coaching Web App gaffrapp.com <i>Next.js, ASP.NET Core Web API, PostgreSQL, Claude API</i> • Founded and developed the product on my own, from the first idea through the architecture to the landing page now live at gaffrapp.com. • Architected every decision in the backend, splitting it into clear Clean Architecture layers with Entity Framework Core and PostgreSQL so data flows stay easy to follow, test, and document. • Decided early that an LLM cannot be trusted with spatial coordinates, so the model only returns a closed-vocabulary JSON movement script and a TypeScript animation engine renders each drill deterministically on the frontend. • Wrapped every model response in a validation layer: strict schema check, reject and retry capped at two attempts, then a text-card fallback, so malformed data never reaches the user. • Wrote a library of 144 drills across a goal by level matrix, and feed recent session history into each prompt so the coaching adapts to the player instead of repeating itself.	
ContactsBook, Full-Stack Contacts Manager <i>ASP.NET Core MVC, EF Core, SQL Server, ClosedXML</i> • Built a role-based contacts manager with five permission levels, full CRUD, search, and server-side filtering. • Added CSV and Excel export of large record sets with ClosedXML, parsing and formatting data to meet a required output format. • Applied security practices including authorization rules, CSRF protection, and admin safeguards.	
RAG Document Chatbot <i>Python, LangChain, ChromaDB, Ollama, Gemma 3</i> • Built a pipeline that parses large documents, splits them on logical boundaries, and tags each chunk with section and page metadata, turning messy source files into a clean, searchable vector store. • Made every answer cite the exact article it came from, so anything the bot says can be checked against the original text. • Handled the case most RAG demos skip: when the retrieved text does not contain the answer, the bot says it does not know instead of making one up. • Built it to work in two languages, Albanian and English. It detects the language of the question and answers in that same language over the same document set. • Ran the whole thing locally on my own machine with Gemma 3 downloaded through Ollama, so no document ever left the computer and the project costs nothing to run.	